Johannes Hollenbach

RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research • Hohenzollernstr. 1–3 • 45128 Essen, Germany
Paderborn University • Warburger Str. 100 • 33098 Paderborn, Germany

johannes.hollenbach@rwi-essen.de • Tel. +49 201 8149 261 • johanneshollenbach.com

Fields

- Primary: Health economics
- Secondary: Labor and education economics

Publications

- Hollenbach, J., Schmitz, H., and Westphal, M. "Gene-Environment Interactions with Essential Heterogeneity." *The Economic Journal* (forthcoming).
- Hollenbach, J., Schmitz, H., and Tawiah, B. "Life-Cycle Health Effects of Compulsory Schooling." *The European Journal of Health Economics* 27(6) (2026).
- Guthmuller, S., Heger, D., Hollenbach, J., and Werbeck, A. "The Impact of Retirement on Loneliness in Europe." *Scientific Reports* 14(1) (2024).
- Geissler, A., Hollenbach, J., Haring, M., Amelung, V., Thun, S., and Haering, A. "A Nationwide Digital Maturity Assessment of Hospitals: Results from the German DigitalRadar." *Health Policy and Technology* 13(4) (2024).
- Vogel, J., Hollenbach, J., Haering, A., Augurzky, B., and Geissler, A. "The Association of Hospital Profitability and Digital Maturity: An Explorative Study Using Data from the German DigitalRadar Project." *Health Policy* 142 (2024).

Work in Progress

- Genetic Endowments and the Long-Run Health Returns to Compulsory Schooling
  Job Market Paper
  Genetic differences tied to educational attainment predict later-life success and wellbeing. I study whether they also moderate how education affects physical health in old age. Using data on individuals aged 65 to 85 from the English Longitudinal Study of Ageing, I exploit the 1947 raising of the school leaving age in the UK from 14 to 15 in a fuzzy regression discontinuity setting to estimate the causal effect of schooling on frailty, the share of age-related health deficits. I estimate interactions with an educational attainment polygenic index (EA PGI), a DNA-based measure of genetic propensity for education. Health returns to schooling rise monotonically along the EA PGI, from zero in the lowest quintile to a 6 percentage point reduction in frailty in the highest. This gradient points to a complementarity between genetic endowments and education. These health improvements originate at the upper part of the frailty distribution. Suggestive evidence on channels indicates reduced smoking, higher physical activity, and a lower probability of receiving a disability pension.

Current Positions

- Paderborn University • Research Associate, Chair of Empirical Economics • since 2024
- RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research • Researcher, Health Economics • since 2021

Education

- Paderborn University • PhD in Economics (Dr. rer. pol.) • since 2022
  Dissertation title: "How Endowments and Policies Shape Major Life Decisions and Healthy Aging"
  Advisor: Hendrik Schmitz
- University of Bayreuth • MSc in Economics • 2021
- University of Bayreuth • BA in International Economics and Development • 2018

VISITS

- University of Wisconsin–Madison • La Follette School of Public Affairs • Fall 2024
  Host: Jason Fletcher
- Vienna University of Economics and Business • Institute for Social Policy • Fall 2021
  Host: Sophie Guthmuller

AWARDS & GRANTS

- Research Exchange Scholarship • RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research • 2024
- Travel Grant • German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) • 2024

INVITED TALKS

- Health Insurance Committee Meeting • German Health Economics Association • Fall 2026
- Applied Micro Workshop • University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee • Fall 2024
- Initiative in Social Genomics • University of Wisconsin–Madison (online) • Spring 2024

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

- 2026 • German Health Economics Association Annual Meeting (Wuppertal), European Social Science Genetics Network Conference (Bologna), Leibniz Resilient Ageing Workshop (Halle)
- 2025 • RWI Brown Bag (Essen), German Health Economics Association Annual Meeting (Paderborn), University of Duisburg-Essen Micro Workshop (Kamen)
- 2024 • ASSA Annual Meeting (San Antonio), Initiative in Social Genomics (UW–Madison), European Health Economics Association PhD & Supervisor Conference (Lucerne), CINCH-dggö Academy in Health Economics (Essen), German Health Economics Association Annual Meeting (Halle), Center for Economic and Statistical Analysis Young Researcher Workshop (Hagen)
- 2023 • European Health Economics Association PhD & Supervisor Conference (Bologna), CINCH-dggö Academy in Health Economics (Essen)
- 2022 • European Health Economics Association PhD & Supervisor Conference (Galway), European Health Economics Association Conference (Oslo), Economics of Mental Health Workshop (Essen), German Health Economics Association Annual Meeting (Hamburg), RWI Brown Bag (Essen)

TEACHING (AS TA)

- Master Thesis Supervision • Paderborn University • since 2024
- Statistics (undergraduate) • Paderborn University • Summer 2025
- Microeconometrics (graduate) • Paderborn University • Summer 2024, Summer 2025
- Empirical Economics (undergraduate) • Paderborn University • Summer 2024
- Healthcare Systems (graduate) • University of Duisburg-Essen • Summer 2024

REFEREEING

Health Economics, Health Policy and Technology, The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis & Policy, The European Journal of Health Economics

OUTREACH

- RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research • PhD Representative (elected) • since 2025
- Young Economic Solutions • Scientific Advisor • 2022, 2023

FURTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- University of Bayreuth • Student Assistant, Chair of Development Economics • 2018–2021
- University of Bayreuth • Student Assistant, Chair of Institutional Economics • 2018–2021

AFFILIATIONS & MEMBERSHIPS

American Economic Association (AEA), German Health Economics Association (dggö)

REFERENCES

- Hendrik Schmitz • Professor of Economics • Paderborn University
  hendrik.schmitz@uni-paderborn.de
- Matthias Westphal • Professor of Economics • FernUniversität in Hagen
  matthias.westphal@fernuni-hagen.de
- Ansgar Wübker • Professor of Economics • Hochschule Harz
  awuebker@hs-harz.de